Holiday Schedule & Time Off Policy

Holiday Schedule 2027

HOLIDAY	**DATE** (off on date/s listed)
New Year's '27	W-F, December 30 - Jan 21
Martin Luther King, Jr Day	M, January 18
President's Day	M, February 15
Memorial Day	M, May 31
Juneteenth	F, June 18 (observed)
Labor Day	M, September 6
Rosh Hashanah	F, October 1
Yom Kippur	M, October 11
Indigenous People's Day	M, October 11
Veteran's Day	Th, November 11
Thanksgiving	W-F, November 24 - 26
Christmas & New Year's	W-F, December 22 - December 31

Key Changes to the 2027 Policy

- **No specific company holiday weeks.** Given how challenging it's been to align our schedules, we're not planning on any specific holiday vacation weeks this year. If we end up going through a particularly intense period, we'll consider adding one.
- **We are extending the end of December company closing period to run from the 22nd - 31st.** At times, we have work we need to do during this period, especially as it's such an important time of year for us, so we will all do our best to avoid meetings, slacks, emails, or calls but there's no guarantee of absolutely zero work! Instead, we will all do our best to allow for maximum time off.

- **A bonus week & $1,000 for meditation retreats.** That said, we're adding a new opportunity this year. All permanent (non-contract / non-temporary) employees can take one additional week off (not counted in your total PTO days) for a meditation retreat and expense $1,000 toward the cost of that retreat.

Time-off Policy and Procedure

- **Working Hours**
    - Our working hours are generally 9:00 a.m. - 5:00 p.m. ET Monday - Friday
    - Calls or meetings outside of these hours may be normal for some, but you should always ask first and understand that colleagues may have commitments outside of these hours and will not be available
    - That said, all employees are encouraged to set working hours in their Google calendar that work best for them; i.e. start and stop when it makes sense to you; block time for kid pick up, lunch, therapy, taking a walk, etc. as long as you are available most days during the majority of working hours.
    - You may receive Slack messages, emails, etc. outside of your work hours; you do not need to check or respond to them until you're back at work. In rare, urgent situations outside of work hours, please text or call instead of using slack or email.

- **Work Week**
    - Full-time employees are expected to work a minimum of 35 hours / week
    - An employee working 30 hours / week will be considered full-time for the purposes of benefits eligibility (decision based on the Affordable Care Act guidelines and a desire to provide flexible working arrangements when it also meets the needs of the business). However, their salary will be pro-rated based on a 35 hour work week. (i.e. 85.7% of the full-time salary for 30 hours)

- **Friday Policy**
    - We will all do our best to neither schedule meetings nor set deadlines on Fridays to allow for some quieter space and autonomy. We won't pull this off 100% of the time, but we'll do our best.

- **Planned OOO Policy**
    - Everyone should take a minimum of 15 planned PTO days annually. Time off is important!
    - Everyone should cap their planned PTO at 25 days annually. Getting our work done together is important, too!

- **Unplanned OOO Policy**
    - If you get sick, need to care for a loved one, etc. obviously these things can't be planned! Please take the time you need.

- If a situation arises where you require more than 5 days of sick or emergency time in one month, you should make reasonable effort to discuss this with your manager so they can make plans to have your workload covered, look out for the workload of others, manage our collective budget (if that is a factor), and consider if leave is appropriate.

- **Comp and Flex Time**
  - If a project requires you to work or travel outside of your normal work hours, you should feel free to take that amount of time off during normal business hours within two weeks. i.e. this flexible system only works if you give yourself the break quickly; piling up comp time and then taking three weeks off will not work ;)

FAQ

- **How will we inform one another/keep track of our Salary Flexible PTO?**
  - Please communicate as early as possible about your days off.
    i. Let your manager know when you're planning to be off during a 1:1.
       1. We want people to be able to enjoy their time away, and to do so without the days immediately before and after being extremely stressful. We also want people to be able to take care of their own work as much as possible.
       2. When your time off is confirmed, take a look at your deadlines leading up to, during, and shortly after your time away and find ways to complete your own tasks on time in a way that doesn't burden others with tight turn-arounds.
       3. When important deadlines or responsibilities are not easy to rearrange, communicate them to your manager and offer a plan for how to proceed.
       4. Allow your manager to also make suggestions for how to best cover and adjust your work and agree on next steps to plan for your time off. (e.g. ask someone to take on a task or respond to certain types of messages for you, get the team's buy-in to push a project deadline, etc.)
  - When you have upcoming PTO, put it in three places:
    i. The "ooo" Slack channel, in the following format:
       1. *I'll be out on self-retreat 4/24-4/26. This will bring me to 3 days of PTO so far.*
       2. *I'll be OOO 6/10-6/12. This will bring me to 7 days of PTO so far.*
    ii. In the OOO / Holiday Google Calendar
    iii. In your personal Google Calendar, on the actual days you are out, so that it's clearly visible for meeting schedule purposes and you show up as away in slack. We're a small team, but still!
       1. To automate this, simply add your Google calendar to the apps connected in slack (on bottom left in slack)

- When you get sick or need to be away from your desk for an extended period of time, put the information in two places:
    i. The “ooo” Slack channel, letting people know how long you’ll be out, e.g.
        1. Woke up with a nasty cold, going to be offline today
        2. Need to take my kid to the doctor, I’ll be out 9-12 ET
    ii. As “ooo” in your personal Google calendar

- **Are the days 'use it or lose it'? Is there a percentage rollover?**
    - Because we are a small team and all deeply reliant on each other - and 25 is a generous maximum - there is no rollover policy.

- **How much notice do we need to give?**
    - If your Planned PTO will be more than three days long, please give notice at least one month in advance.

- **What are the team norms for rescheduling meetings when you are going to be OOO?**
    - For any meeting you own, please reschedule the meeting if it is necessary, and delete the meeting if it is not.
    - If it’s a standing weekly meeting where you are not typically a decision maker or executor, just let the organizer know you will not be attending by declining the meeting and sending a slack message.
    - For any meeting where you are a key stakeholder, let the meeting organizer know you will not be present and request they reschedule.
    - 1:1s: General rule of thumb is:
        i. If you are out a day or two and will miss your 1:1, rebook it for a different day that week if possible.
        ii. If you’re out a full week, just delete the check in for that week.

- **What are the team norms for out of office messages:**
    - Put up an out of office message anytime you’re going to be away from your inbox for a day or more.
    - If you’re out for more than two days, let external contacts know where they can direct their message.
        i. Let your colleagues know that you’re listing them as an out of office contact for a particular topic and get their consent.